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CS300

Sprint Review and Retrospective

VARIOUS ROLES AND THEIR CONTRIBUTION TO PROJECT SUCCESS

Scrum Master:

The Scrum Master role helped set the SNHU Travel project up for success by holding daily stand ups. We can see in assignment 2-3 that the scrum master's sole responsibility is to hold daily stand ups and allow the team members (specifically testers and developers) to decide where they are succeeding and where they are struggling. The Scrum Master helps facilitate effective communication and conflict resolution within the team through their key traits of leadership, facilitation, and coaching as talked about in the 2-1 Discussion. This leads to increased productivity and communication among the team which helps foster the success of a project.

Product Owner:

The Product Owner's main job is facilitating communication between the technical and non-technical so clients can better understand what exactly the development team is doing and vice versa. This is usually presented in the way of user stories like the ones developed in assignment 3-2. This assignment given to the Product Owner allowed the testers to generate clear to read goals and measures of success within those goals. They help the team achieve success in the project by creating a product backlog which is a list

of everything that the client requested within their project and sorted them into the size of the task. This allows all developers and testers to know what needs to be tackled before work on the project (and refined user stories) are initiated.

Tester:

The tester's main job is to produce test cases for the development team. This helps clear up any confusion and miscommunication that may happen between a developer and product owner. They help foster success through these test cases by giving clearly outline pass/fail goals for the development team to follow when they start working on their next part of the project. In assignment 4-2, we see a clear example of these test cases and how they facilitate success and more refined goals when applied to the prototype slideshow created.

Developer:

The developer's job is to produce the product a client wants. They facilitate success in generating code in a timely manner (usually in 1–4-week sprints) that can then be presented to the client. Having code done in a timely manner is crucial for the project to continue on and meet the standards the client(s) have in mind. Another way developers ensure success in a project is through their ability to respond and adapt to unforeseen changes. We see this specifically with the prototype slideshow at the start of the project compared to the second prototype after the test cases were produced.

SCRUM-AGILE APPROACH TO SDLC AND USER STORIES

The scrum-agile approach to the Software Development Lifecycle helped user stories come to completion by allowing the production to favor the end user. For example, in assignment 3-2, we created a user story for an end user that wanted to be able to use SNHU Travel to find the best possible deal for potential destinations. We asked the end user how we would be able to do this for them and they suggested a sorting system to sort destinations based on price. From this, the development team can come up with ways to approach this task based on the acceptance criteria given by the end user. This ultimately changes the entire development process of the project from focusing on smaller details to focusing on the larger picture at hand.

SCRUM-AGILE APPROACH TO INTERRUPTIONS AND CHANGING DIRECTIONS

The scrum-agile approach supported project completion even when interruptions occurred through fast development of a new prototype and team collaboration. In assignment 5-2, the developers were notified that the client wanted to go in a different direction and have a slideshow surrounding wellness resorts and trips with hyperlinks embedded. Through agile methods, like daily standups and constant collaboration, the development team was able to produce this new prototype quickly giving these new directions whenever they are made available from the client.

COMMUNICATION AMONG TEAM MEMBERS

My ability to communicate with my team members comes in the form of the module 6 group discussion. An example of this is when I communicated with one of the testers:

> Hi Brandon!

> I love your ideas for transforming our workplace and how it runs! You mentioned that one concern is clear user stories. One of our testers, Owen, mentioned in my post where I provided the idea about partner programming to eliminate the need for specialists about having testers join in on partner programming. How would you feel about this idea? Do you think having testers join in on partner programming and learn some of these skills or be available for clarifying questions on user stories, especially during the beginning of our transition, would help developers and testers get on the same page about what is required and how it is being implemented?
>
> Excited to work with you! Looking forward to your response!

This communication with the fellow developer shows how I asked a question about an idea a previous tester came to me with. Having open communication allows teammates to pose ideas to others that may have not been included in the discussion or missed the question. This helped the team come to a decision on having testers included in partner programming by having everyone contribute to the conversation.

SCRUM-AGILE PRINCIPLES AND ORGANIZATIONAL TOOLS

The main organizational tools used in the creation of the SNHU Travel project were user stories, test cases, and daily stand ups. These foster the main principles of agile; namely the principles surrounding collaboration, customer satisfaction, and reflection. User stories help foster the principle of customer satisfaction by trying to solve issues directly presented by the client and/or users of the software. Test cases help foster the principle of customer satisfaction by refining the user stories into easily definable pass/fail test cases in what the end user and/or client desires. Daily stand ups foster the principle of collaboration and

reflection by allowing the team to communicate about what is happening that is successful and what is happening that is not as successful. This allows the team to focus on issues that may be more pressing or causing more roadblocks among the team. It also allows each member to speak up or ask for help from others.

THE EFFECTIVENESS OF SCRUM-AGILE IN SNHU TRAVEL

Overall, there were multiple pros and cons to using agile within the SNHU Travel Project. One advantage of agile within the SNHU Travel Project was the ability to change directions in a relatively quick and seamless way because it is set up to constantly be iterated upon and requires constant feedback/communication with the client and team members. Under the waterfall method, changes become more disruptive to the flow since the method is based on a more rigid approach to projects. However, the ability for a client to have constant changes within the agile approach may cause the team members to lose sight of the larger picture.

Even with these disadvantages, SNHU Travel benefitted from the scrum-agile approach and delivered a quality prototype for the client that fit the requirements and specifications. This deliverable was made possible by constant communication within the team as well as the ability to adapt to change.